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MySQL UNION Operator

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The MySQL UNION Operator

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The `UNION` operator is used to combine the result-set of two or more `SELECT` statements.

The `UNION` operator automatically removes duplicate rows from the result set.

Requirements for `UNION`:

- Every `SELECT` statement within `UNION` must have the same number of columns
- The columns must also have similar data types
- The columns in every `SELECT` statement must also be in the same order

UNION Syntax

```
SELECT column_name(s) FROM table1
UNION
```

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Note: The column names in the result-set are usually equal to the column names in the first `SELECT` statement.

Demo Database

Below is a selection from the "Customers" table:

CustomerID	CustomerName	ContactName	Address	City	PostalCode	Cou
1	Alfreds Futterkiste	Maria Anders	Obere Str. 57	Berlin	12209	Gerr
2	Ana Trujillo Emparedados y helados	Ana Trujillo	Avda. de la Constitución 2222	México D.F.	05021	Mex
3	Antonio Moreno Taquería	Antonio Moreno	Mataderos 2312	México D.F.	05023	Mex

And a selection from the "Suppliers" table:

SupplierID	SupplierName	ContactName	Address	City	PostalCode	Country
1	Exotic Liquid	Charlotte Cooper	49 Gilbert St.	London	EC1 4SD	UK
2	New Orleans Cajun Delights	Shelley Burke	P.O. Box 78934	New Orleans	70117	USA

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MySQL UNION Example

The following SQL returns the cities (only distinct values) from both the "Customers" and the "Suppliers" table:

Example

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```
SELECT City FROM Customers
UNION
SELECT City FROM Suppliers
ORDER BY City;
```

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MySQL UNION With WHERE

Here we add a `WHERE` clause to only return the unique German cities from both the "Customers" and the "Suppliers" table:

Example

```
SELECT City, Country FROM Customers
WHERE Country='Germany'
UNION
SELECT City, Country FROM Suppliers
WHERE Country='Germany'
ORDER BY City;
```

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Example

```
SELECT 'Customer' AS Type, ContactName, City, Country
FROM Customers
UNION
SELECT 'Supplier', ContactName, City, Country
FROM Suppliers;
```

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Notice the "AS Type" above - it is an alias. SQL Aliases are used to give a table or a column a temporary name. So, here we have created a temporary column named "Type", that list whether the contact person is a "Customer" or a "Supplier".

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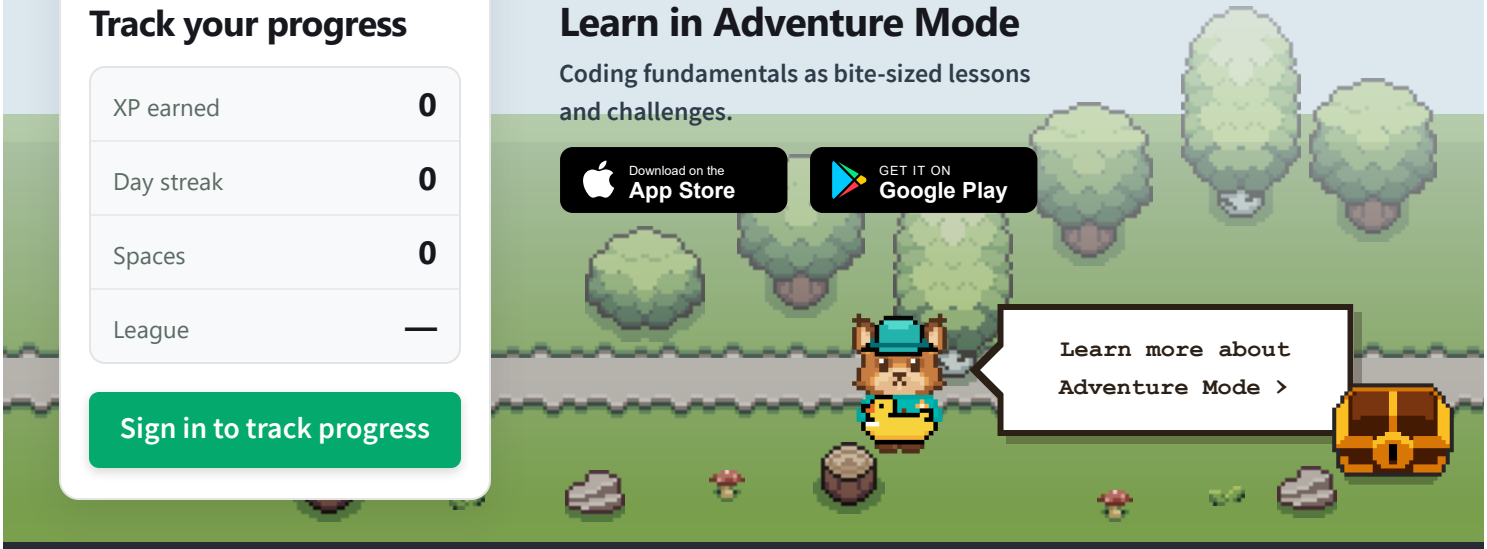
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